Despite the clean-up, some remnants of the Master Cell remained. One of its sub-cells, Poster Cell-1, had a rather nondescript member called Ghulam Rasool Zahgir. In the book cited earlier, Swami has comprehensively catalogued and tracked the trajectory of the evolution of Zahgir as a master terrorist. In fact, it will not be out of place to credit Zahgir for being the father of Pakistani subversion in Jammu and Kashmir. In mafia parlance, he was the *capo di tutti capi* or the boss of all the bosses. Men like Masood Azhar, Hafiz Sayeed and Syed Salahuddin were worthy successors of this trailblazer. Zahgir showed the way to initiate and execute subversion in the valley with the support of the PIB and the ISI. The Jaish-e-Mohammed and Lashkar-e-Taiba had only to follow his trail.

Zahgir was detained on 21 October 1965. However, since he was then only on the fringes of the ring, he was released on parole in January 1966. Indian intelligence had unfortunately underestimated him. Upon his release, he established contact with intelligence operatives working out of the Pakistan High Commission in New Delhi. They asked him to develop contacts with underground student groups like the Students' Revolutionary Council. Zahgir's arrival charged up this group and he took over their leadership. By December 1966, Zahgir and his group mailed posters bearing a map of India with Jammu and Kashmir coloured red and marked as a separate entity to a wide range of people in Jammu and Kashmir. This act caused his group to be named 'Red Kashmir'. However, his handlers at the Pakistan High Commission wanted him to do much more.

In Srinagar, on the night of 3 February 1967, a BSF constable was on duty at the Nawakadal Bridge. He was armed with a .303 army-issued rifle, loaded with five rounds in its chamber. Armed with daggers, Zahgir and Sarwar stabbed the BSF guard in the chest. Officials at the Maharaj Gunj Police Station registered a First Information Report recording the murder but had no information on who carried it out. The police investigation of the Nawakadal murder moved no further even after Red Kashmir claimed responsibility for the murder in the next issue of its newsletter. Soon after the murder, Zahgir was arrested under the Defence of India rules because of intelligence reports that said that he had resumed his anti-India activities.